

American Restoration and Resilience Project

Public Demo Packet: Front Page, DOJ-001, Proposed Legislation, and Framework

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Front Page

American Restoration and Resilience Project (ARRP)

A Roadmap for Repairing Institutional Damage, Restoring Trustworthy Government, and Preventing Future Personalist Capture

Reader notice

The author is an independent researcher and does not have formal legal training. This project is a policy-reform research and drafting exercise, not legal advice. Proposed legislation, model acts, constitutional amendments, and administrative language in this repository are illustrative working drafts. They have not been reviewed or approved by an attorney, legislative counsel, legal scholar, public official, or affected institution, and should not be treated as final or ready-to-introduce legislative text.

This project is intended to be institution-focused and nonpartisan in its standards, methods, and proposed remedies. It is not neutral about institutional abuse, democratic backsliding, corruption, personalist capture, rule-of-law failure, or unitary executive theory, and it is transparent about seeking to reverse, repair, and prevent institutional outcomes associated with Project 2025 and similar efforts to subordinate public institutions to personal or factional control. The project uses real-world examples to identify structural vulnerabilities and possible repairs, not to advance a party program or defend or condemn any person, party, administration, or ideology as such. Proposed remedies are meant to apply prospectively and evenhandedly across parties, officeholders, and political circumstances.

The project does not claim or intend to function as a Democratic Party agenda. At the same time, it does not ignore the practical reality that some readers, lawmakers, advocates, or institutions may be more receptive to the project because of the present political alignment of the abuses it studies. That likely audience does not define the project's standards. The project should remain candid about coalition realities while continuing to frame proposals as institutional repairs that can be evaluated, improved, supported, or criticized on their merits.

The project does not avoid naming public actors, including President Trump, where specific conduct is relevant to identifying institutional damage, structural vulnerability, or necessary repair. Such references are not included as partisan argument or personal condemnation for its own sake, but because the project depends on concrete examples of how institutions were damaged, tested, or exploited. The same standards should apply to any officeholder, party, administration, or movement that creates comparable institutional risk.

The full neutrality, language, coalition-reality, and political-language audit rules are maintained in the technical framework and project methodology. See `framework/Framework.md` and `framework/METHODOLOGY.md`.

The project is also a living research draft. Sources, citations, examples, issue classifications, and proposed remedies may be incomplete, provisional, or later revised as the work develops.

The project is author-directed. The author has set the research agenda, selected and organized the issues, made the editorial judgments, and remained in charge of the project's structure and development. Large language model tools, including ChatGPT, have been used extensively for research organization, drafting assistance, revision, comparison, and issue spotting, but the project was not generated from scratch by an LLM. The author asserts authorship of the project as a whole and remains responsible for its editorial choices, judgments, omissions, and errors.

For a dedicated authorship statement, see `AUTHORS.md`.

Foundational Premise

The American system of government is broken because it failed to prevent President Trump and the MAGA movement from subordinating constitutional duty, institutional independence, factual adjudication, and the peaceful transfer of power to personal loyalty. The damage must be repaired, the weaknesses that enabled it must be corrected, and stronger safeguards must be established against future personalist capture.

This project was not devised as a partisan response to partisan policy preferences, nor as a counter-platform to Project 2025. It analyzes outcomes associated with President Trump's administration, MAGA-aligned efforts, Project 2025, and other partisan or ideological projects only where they reveal, exploit, accelerate, or manifest institutional damage. The project's concern is the legal, structural, administrative, and institutional vulnerability, not the partisan identity of the actor or the ordinary policy preference at issue.

The project is designed for readers who accept the project's underlying premise and foundational diagnosis. Its purpose is not to repeatedly prove that the system is broken, but to determine how the failure occurred, what damage followed, which weaknesses allowed it, what must be repaired, and what reforms can prevent recurrence.

Mission

The project will:

1. identify the principal institutional damage caused, accelerated, revealed, or exploited by President Trump, the MAGA movement, Project 2025, or comparable efforts;
2. identify the legal, structural, administrative, and policy weaknesses that made that damage possible;

3. distinguish repair of existing damage from prevention of recurrence; and
4. develop a durable roadmap for restoring lawful and trustworthy government.

Scope

The project concerns systems, structures, institutions, laws, and policies. It does not attempt a comprehensive sociological account of voter psychology, cultural identity, or partisan affiliation except where those matters directly illuminate an institutional vulnerability or remedy.

Governing Principles

Institutional Focus

President Trump is the principal case study, but the institutional weakness is the subject of analysis. Each issue must identify the legal, structural, administrative, institutional, or policy vulnerability that enabled, permitted, or failed to constrain the abuse. The project should not conclude merely that "President Trump is the problem."

Neutral Application

The project is not neutral about abuse, but it is neutral about who may commit it. Evidence may involve presidents or administrations of either party where supported by reliable evidence, and safeguards must apply equally regardless of political affiliation.

The project rejects false equivalence, partisan exemptions, unsupported accusations, and rules that apply differently depending on who holds power.

Truth and Reconciliation

The project seeks truth, legal coherence, factual accountability, and reconciliation grounded in an honest record. Where evidence establishes responsibility, the project should state it directly. Where uncertainty remains, it should identify the uncertainty rather than manufacture balance.

Restoration and Reform

The objective is not automatic return to the pre-2017 institutional status quo. Where prior arrangements enabled abuse, restoration must include redesign and legal hardening.

Functional Administrative Independence

Elected officials should control lawful policy direction. Factual determination, scientific assessment, adjudication, auditing, personnel administration, and individual enforcement decisions should receive protection from personal or partisan coercion.

Institutional Corrigibility

Not every institutional abuse can be prevented without impairing legitimate governmental authority, eliminating necessary discretion, or creating an equally serious countervailing danger. Where complete prevention is impracticable, the project should establish the least-complex adequate means by which abuse can be detected, documented, reviewed, exposed, remedied, deterred, and prevented from becoming entrenched.

A remedy may therefore be adequate even when it cannot prevent the first violation, provided it creates a credible and durable avenue for institutional self-correction. The analysis should distinguish prevention, detection, correction, deterrence, and containment rather than treating them as interchangeable.

Institutional corrigibility is not an excuse for weak reform. Preventive safeguards remain preferable where they are lawful, workable, and proportionate. Corrigibility becomes central where stronger front-end control would destroy necessary discretion, create unconstitutional supervision, or impose a cure more damaging than the underlying risk.

How to Read an Issue Page

Developed issue pages are designed to move from problem to remedy before turning to scoring and technical notes. Common sections include:

- **Issue Snapshot:** brief problem, repair, and vehicle summary.
- **Institutional Anomaly:** the structural defect the issue addresses.
- **Manifestation of the Failure:** representative facts showing the defect in operation.
- **Resulting Damage:** institutional, legal, administrative, or legitimacy harm.
- **Underlying Weakness:** the law, structure, procedure, remedy, or norm that failed.
- **Proposal Survey:** existing law, prior proposals, or adjacent models considered.
- **Least-Complex Adequate Remedy:** the preferred remedy and why it is sufficient.

- **Repair and Prevention:** how the proposal repairs damage and reduces recurrence.
- **Proposed Legislation:** linked draft bill, rule, amendment, manual text, or procedural vehicle.
- **Adoption Viability Note:** why a legally available vehicle may still require a future or amenable actor.
- **Relationship to Adjacent Proposals:** how overlapping ARRP proposals differ, merge, or complement one another.
- **Budgetary Impact Statement:** preliminary fiscal or workload classification, not an official cost score.
- **Proposal Scoring:** compact readiness, adoption, friction, pathway, review, and audit-status summary.
- **Annotation:** evidence, qualifications, legal analysis, alternatives, implementation limits, and score explanations.
- **Audit History:** linked technical sidecar preserving the full audit record.

Proposal Scores

Issue pages may include a **Proposal Quality Score** from 0 to 100. The score is a planning and readiness signal, not a claim that the proposal is correct, final, popular, legally valid, or certain to pass. It measures how well the proposal has been developed, sourced, tested against existing law, checked for implementation risk, and prepared for review.

Score bands are interpreted as follows:

Score	Meaning
0	Not Scored: retired, merged, moot, pending development, or awaiting a controlling finding.
1-49	Early/Partial Draft: major unresolved source, legal, remedy, or structure issues.
50-64	Developed Draft: meaningful structure but incomplete audit support.
65-74	Substantially Developed Draft: useful internally but still has material unresolved issues.
75-84	Review Ready: strong enough for knowledgeable external critique, but not yet proposal-ready.
85-89	Advanced Review Ready: most internal checks are complete, but key validation remains.
90-94	Proposal Ready: mature enough for serious proposal packets or stakeholder circulation, with caveats.
95-99	Publication Ready: rare and heavily validated.
100	Fully Validated: theoretically possible but not expected for most reforms.

The full scoring formula and audit rules are maintained in `framework/METHODOLOGY.md`.

Some issue pages also show an **Adoption Score** from 0 to 12. This is part of the Proposal Quality Score, not a separate score. It measures whether the proposal has a realistic, evidence-supported adoption path, including likely audiences, good-faith objections, coalition strategy, current support evidence, and the required electoral environment.

Adoption score bands are interpreted as follows:

Score	Meaning
0	Unassessed: adoption path has not been scored.
1-3	Weak Adoption Basis: adoption path is mostly undeveloped or unsupported.
4-6	Limited Adoption Basis: some adoption logic exists, but key evidence is missing.
7-9	Credible Adoption Basis: adoption path is reasonably developed and partly evidenced.
10-11	Strong Adoption Basis: adoption path is well developed and well supported.
12	Exceptional Adoption Basis: adoption path is unusually complete and strongly evidenced.

Some issue pages also show **Coalition Support Estimates** for Democratic, Republican, independent, or bipartisan audiences. These percentages are provisional planning judgments, not polling claims. They estimate how likely each audience is to find the proposal supportable in principle based on the proposal's framing, institutional purpose, current public evidence, prior legislative behavior, stakeholder signals, good-faith objections, and audit judgment. They should be revised when better polling, expert review, legislative behavior, stakeholder feedback, or coalition analysis becomes available.

Some issue pages may also show **External Review Status** when a qualified professional or institutional reviewer has reviewed the proposal. External review can increase the Proposal Quality Score only when the review is documented, within the reviewer's domain, and incorporated into the audit record. Qualified reviewers may include relevant attorneys, legislative counsel, legislators or legislative staff, law professors, public-law scholars, government practitioners, inspectors general or ethics professionals, subject-matter experts, or affected institutional stakeholders. External review is not a guarantee that a proposal is legally valid, final, or certain to pass.

Some issue pages also include an **Adoption Friction Score** from 0 to 100. This is separate from Proposal Quality. It estimates how much resistance, litigation risk, procedural blockade, public misunderstanding, or institutional opposition a proposal is likely to face. A higher friction score does not mean the proposal is worse; it means adoption will likely require more coalition work, explanation, staging, or litigation planning.

Adoption friction bands are interpreted as follows:

Score	Meaning
0-20	Low Resistance: likely to face limited organized opposition or implementation friction.
21-40	Manageable Resistance: likely to face ordinary objections but no major structural barrier.
41-60	Significant Resistance: likely to require active coalition work, explanation, or implementation planning.
61-80	High Resistance: likely to face organized opposition, litigation risk, or serious procedural barriers.
81-100	Extreme Resistance: likely to face intense opposition, major litigation, or exceptional adoption barriers.
Unassessed	Not yet scored.

Some issue pages also include a **Required Electoral Environment** descriptor. This is not a separate score. It states, in plain terms, what political or institutional condition would likely need to exist before the proposal could realistically move. The descriptor helps calibrate adoption and implementation risk; it does not mean the proposal is weak, undesirable, or impossible.

current-law-available means a legal or institutional vehicle already exists; it does not mean the current officeholder or institution is likely to adopt the proposal. Where adoption depends on voluntary self-limitation by the same actor whose discretion would be constrained, the Adoption Score and Adoption Friction Score should reflect that practical barrier.

Common descriptors are interpreted as follows:

Descriptor	Meaning
current-law-available	Existing law, rule, or authority may already permit action.
not-electorally-dependent	The proposal does not mainly depend on an election outcome.
house-oversight-majority	A House majority could advance oversight, hearings, subpoenas, or reports.
narrow-unified-government	Same-party control is likely needed, but margins may be tight.
filibuster-constrained-unified-government	Unified government may still face Senate filibuster limits.
sixty-vote-senate	Ordinary Senate passage likely requires a 60-vote coalition.
filibuster-reform-or-exception	Passage likely requires changing or bypassing the filibuster.
wave-election-mandate	The proposal likely needs a major electoral shift.
post-crisis-repair-mandate	Adoption likely requires a public crisis or institutional reckoning.
constitutional-amendment-environment	Adoption would require Article V-level national and state support.
state-level-pathway	The proposal is more viable through state action or state models.
unassessed	The electoral environment has not yet been assessed.

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Citation

For citation metadata, see `CITATION.cff`. The preferred citation may be updated when the project is formally released for broader public use.

DOJ-001

DOJ-001 — Recent Presidential Personal Counsel in Senior DOJ Leadership

Issue Snapshot

Problem: Recent presidential counsel can control DOJ.

Repair: Seven-year top-DOJ cooling-off rule.

Vehicle: 28 U.S.C. §§ 503–504a amendments (draft).

Institutional Anomaly

The appointment framework does not adequately protect the Department of Justice from control by a president’s recent personal counsel, especially where the prior representation involved criminal exposure or matters touching presidential power.

Manifestation of the Failure

President Trump nominated Todd Blanche, described by the Associated Press as President Trump’s former defense attorney, for senior Department leadership; the Senate confirmed Blanche as Deputy Attorney General in March 2025. See Associated Press and Congress.gov PN12-5. As of the June 27, 2026 T4 publication-ready audit, DOJ’s own pages list Blanche as both Acting Attorney General and Deputy Attorney General, making the manifestation broader than the original Deputy Attorney General confirmation alone. The Guardian separately reported on June 8, 2026 that President Trump nominated Blanche to serve as Attorney General; that report is treated as a source lead pending verification against an official nomination record. See The Guardian.

A June 2026 Associated Press report also shows why matter-specific conflict litigation is not a substitute for a structural appointment rule. In a prosecution involving an alleged attack connected to the White House Correspondents’ Association dinner, a federal judge rejected a defendant’s request to disqualify Acting Attorney General Blanche and D.C. U.S. Attorney Jeanine Pirro from supervisory involvement. The ruling did not address Blanche’s prior representation of President Trump, so it should not be overstated; it is useful here only because it illustrates that case-by-case disqualification may fail even where senior DOJ officials’ proximity to a charged event is challenged. See Associated Press.

Resulting Damage

The arrangement creates a structural conflict between public law-enforcement responsibility and a recent relationship of personal loyalty, confidential knowledge, and strategic alignment. It also undermines confidence that Department decisions affecting the president, his associates, or political opponents are institutionally independent.

Underlying Weakness

Existing ethics and recusal rules are primarily matter-specific and internally administered. They do not fully address department-wide authority, personnel influence, access to information, agenda control, or the legitimacy costs created by placing recent personal counsel at the head of federal law enforcement.

Proposal Survey

Existing federal models use targeted eligibility limits and cooling-off periods rather than broad personal-disqualification regimes. The Secretary of Defense statute bars appointment within seven years after active-duty commissioned service unless Congress grants a waiver. See 10 U.S.C. § 113. Federal post-employment restrictions separately regulate former officers’ later appearances and communications, showing Congress’s willingness to address relationship-based conflicts through time-limited rules. See 18 U.S.C. § 207.

DOJ’s own conflict rules also provide a narrower internal analogue, requiring disqualification from criminal investigations or prosecutions where a personal or political relationship exists unless participation is authorized. See 28 C.F.R. § 45.2. The executive-branch impartiality rule similarly treats recent attorney, consultant, contractor, officer, and employee relationships as covered relationships that can require nonparticipation in particular matters. See 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502. DOJ-001 builds from those models but applies them at the appointment-eligibility stage, where matter-specific screening is insufficient.

The T4 publication-ready audit did not identify a direct prior bill using the same personal-presidential-counsel eligibility rule. The closest statutory models are therefore structural analogues: the Secretary of Defense cooling-off qualification, Senate-confirmation nominee disclosure timing, Office of Government Ethics review authority, and existing DOJ and executive-branch impartiality rules.

A closer adjacent legislative analogue is the Protecting Our Democracy Act, H.R. 5314, 117th Congress. Title VI, the “Security from Political Interference in Justice Act of 2020,” would have required DOJ communications logs for covered communications involving contemplated or ongoing DOJ investigations or litigation and periodic disclosure to the DOJ Inspector General. Congress.gov records that H.R. 5314 passed the House 220-208, had 168 cosponsors, and was received in the Senate. This does not establish precedent for a personal-counsel eligibility rule, but it does show prior House-passed legislative interest in insulating DOJ from White House political interference.

Least-Complex Adequate Remedy

Congress should amend 28 U.S.C. §§ 503, 504, and 504a to make a person ineligible to be appointed or serve as Attorney General, Deputy Attorney General, or Associate Attorney General during the seven years after personally providing covered legal representation or advice to the sitting President. Covered representation should include private, personal, electoral, criminal-defense, civil-liability, impeachment, or comparable matters in which the President's interests were distinct from, or could reasonably diverge from, the interests of the United States. Official legal service performed solely on behalf of the United States or the Executive Office of the President should be excluded. This mirrors Congress's established use of a cooling-off qualification for the Secretary of Defense under 10 U.S.C. § 113, uses existing statutory hooks for the senior DOJ offices in the Attorney General succession line, and directly addresses the conflict without creating a new institution.

Repair and Prevention

Repair requires transparent disclosure, independent Office of Government Ethics review, enforceable screening, and verification that affected matters are insulated. Prevention requires rules addressing recent personal representation before appointment to the Attorney General, Deputy Attorney General, or Associate Attorney General offices. The T3 audit added a narrow judicial-review path for the covered individual and people directly subject to DOJ action substantially involving the allegedly ineligible official, while preventing automatic invalidation of DOJ actions absent an independent remedial basis and particularized prejudice.

Proposed Legislation

- Seven-Year Cooling-Off Rule for Senior Justice Department Eligibility

Budgetary Impact Statement

Administrative workload is possible through nominee disclosure, OGE review, DOJ ethics consultation, Senate review, and occasional expedited judicial review; no new appropriation is specified and no dollar estimate is assigned.

Note: Preliminary ARRP assessment only; not a CBO, OMB, agency, or legislative-counsel score.

Proposal Scoring

Proposal Quality Score: 82 / 100 (Review Ready)

Adoption Score: 5 / 12 (Limited Adoption Basis)

Coalition Support Estimates:

Democratic 80%

Independent 60%

Republican 40%

Bipartisan viability 55%

Adoption Friction: 72 / 100 (High Resistance)

Required Electoral Environment: sixty-vote-senate

Development Priority: active

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Audit Status: T4 publication-ready audit complete; 2026-06-27.2 change audit no score effect

Last Audit: Change Audit

Rubric Version: 2026-06-27.2; **Rebaseline:** current

Next Audit: T4 follow-up after Slaughter decision, official AG nomination record, and external review

Full Audit History: DOJ-001 audit history

Annotation

Basis and Evidence. Former-client duties continue after representation ends, but they generally operate through confidentiality and matter-specific conflict rules. Senior Department leadership exercises authority extending beyond any single matter through supervision, personnel, policy, information access, and enforcement priorities. The current T4 source base includes Congress.gov PN12-5 for Todd Blanche's Deputy Attorney General nomination and confirmation, Associated Press reporting describing Blanche as President Trump's former defense attorney, 28 U.S.C. §§ 503, 504, 504a, and 508 for the Attorney General, Deputy Attorney General, Associate Attorney General, and succession statutory hooks, 10 U.S.C. § 113 for the cooling-off analogue, 5 U.S.C. § 13103 for nominee disclosure timing, 5 U.S.C. § 13122 for OGE review authority, 28 C.F.R. § 45.2 and 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502 for conflict and impartiality analogues, ABA Model Rule 1.9 for former-client professional-responsibility duties, and H.R. 5314 as an adjacent prior-legislative model for DOJ political-interference controls.

Qualification. Prior representation does not create a perpetual duty to advance a former client's interests, and appointment of a former attorney is not automatically unlawful. The identified defect is the inadequacy of existing institutional safeguards, not a categorical assertion that current professional-responsibility law forbids the appointment.

Remedial Alternatives and Constraints. Disclosure, recusal, and screening alone are simpler but do not adequately address department-wide authority or institutional legitimacy. A broader prohibition covering any attorney who served in any legal capacity would be easier to state but constitutionally more vulnerable and unnecessarily overinclusive. The proposed rule therefore should be

temporary, generally applicable, and limited to personal or politically interested representation. Congress's use of office-specific cooling-off qualifications supports the design, but it is a statutory analogue rather than controlling judicial precedent. Full proposed legislative language is maintained separately in the project's Legislative Drafting Proposals under DOJ-001.

Judicial Scrutiny. The strongest constitutional argument for DOJ-001 is that Congress created the senior DOJ offices by statute, already defines their appointment structure, and may attach narrow office-specific eligibility conditions without changing the Appointments Clause process. The bill preserves presidential nomination and Senate advice-and-consent, does not create tenure protection, does not restrict removal, and does not assign appointment power to Congress. See *Buckley v. Valeo* for the Appointments Clause baseline that officers exercising significant federal authority must be appointed through constitutionally prescribed methods. The strongest constitutional objection is that the Attorney General, Deputy Attorney General, and Associate Attorney General exercise core executive law-enforcement authority, and current Supreme Court doctrine is protective of presidential control over officers who exercise executive power. See *Myers v. United States*, *Seila Law LLC v. CFPB*, and *Trump v. United States*. The proposal's best durability strategy is to frame the rule as a prospective, neutral, conflict-based eligibility condition rather than as a removal limit, prosecution rule, or punishment of a named person.

Pending Judicial Vulnerability. As of the June 27, 2026 T4 publication-ready audit, *Trump v. Slaughter* had been argued and no final merits judgment was identified on the docket. The case concerns presidential removal power and whether courts may prevent a person's removal from public office. It does not directly decide whether Congress may set appointment eligibility for DOJ offices, but it could affect judicial receptivity to structural remedies involving executive officers. DOJ-001 should be rechecked after *Slaughter* is decided, especially if the Court broadly limits equitable relief concerning federal officeholding.

Enforcement Design. The T3 audit concluded that broad private, taxpayer, voter, or legislator standing would be weak and should not be the enforcement backbone. The bill now uses a narrower review channel for the covered individual and for people directly subject to DOJ action personally authorized, directed, supervised, or substantially participated in by the allegedly ineligible official. It also limits automatic invalidation of DOJ actions to reduce de facto-officer disruption and separation-of-powers risk.

Budgetary Impact. DOJ-001 specifies no appropriation and does not create a new office. The expected burden is administrative: nominee disclosure, OGE review, possible DOJ Designated Agency Ethics Official consultation, Senate Judiciary receipt and consideration, and occasional expedited litigation in the U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia if the eligibility rule is contested. No dollar estimate is assigned because no CBO, OMB, agency, legislative-counsel, historical appropriation, or audited program-cost source has been identified for this proposal.

Quality Score. The 82/100 score reflects a review-ready proposal with strong structure, source support, legal fit, remedy design, abuse resistance, drafting quality, cogency, and project integration. It remains below proposal-ready status because no external legal or legislative review has been incorporated, no proposal-specific polling has been found, no direct prior bill using the same personal-presidential-counsel eligibility rule has been identified, no official Attorney General nomination record has been verified, and *Trump v. Slaughter* still requires follow-up.

Adoption Score. The 5/12 score is limited because the current evidence supports the general public-trust concern but not the specific seven-year cooling-off mechanism.

Coalition Support Estimates. The coalition support estimates are provisional planning judgments, not polling evidence.

Adoption Friction. The 72/100 score is high because the proposal concerns senior DOJ eligibility, presidential appointment discretion, separation-of-powers doctrine, a live manifestation involving President Trump, likely stakeholder opposition, public-messaging risk, and probable litigation.

Required Electoral Environment. The required environment is *sixty-vote-senate* because the current vehicle is ordinary federal legislation likely subject to Senate cloture unless attached to another viable vehicle or paired with procedural reform.

Development Priority. The priority remains *active* because the proposal is coherent and useful, but should be staged with narrower disclosure, OGE-review, confirmation-process, or oversight variants.

Support and Adoption. The T4 audit found public-opinion evidence supporting the general institutional concern but not the specific DOJ-001 mechanism. A January 2025 AP-NORC poll found low public confidence that DOJ and the FBI would act fairly and nonpartisan during President Trump's second term, including uncertainty among Republicans. That supports the salience of DOJ independence, but it does not measure support for a seven-year personal-counsel cooling-off rule. The adoption score therefore remains 5/12.

Publication Readiness. DOJ-001 is a strong developed draft, not yet a publication-ready proposal. Before public circulation, the project should obtain external legal or legislative review, verify any official Attorney General nomination record if one becomes available, reassess the enforcement design after *Trump v. Slaughter*, and decide whether to add a staged fallback vehicle focused on disclosure, OGE review, or Senate-confirmation procedure.

Appendix A - Proposed Legislation for DOJ-001

DOJ-001 — Seven-Year Cooling-Off Rule for Senior Justice Department Eligibility

Statutory Analogue

The proposal uses the office-specific cooling-off structure found in 10 U.S.C. § 113(a)(2), which restricts appointment of certain recently retired commissioned officers as Secretary of Defense. That provision is a legislative analogue and historical practice, not a controlling judicial holding on the constitutionality of the proposed Attorney General qualification.

Proposed Amendment

Section 503 of title 28, United States Code, is amended by designating the existing text as subsection (a) and adding at the end the following:

- (b)(1)** A person may not be appointed to, or serve in, the office of Attorney General during the seven-year period following the termination of covered legal representation of the sitting President.
- (2)** In this subsection, the term “covered legal representation” means personal legal representation, advice, or advocacy provided directly to—
- (A)** the President;
- (B)** the President-elect; or
- (C)** a candidate for President who subsequently becomes the sitting President, in connection with a criminal investigation or proceeding, civil-enforcement matter, impeachment or removal proceeding, election or campaign matter, personal financial or business interest, claim of personal immunity, or any other matter in which the represented individual’s interests were distinct from, or could reasonably diverge from, the interests of the United States.
- (3)** Covered legal representation does not include legal service performed solely in an official capacity on behalf of the United States, an agency of the United States, or the Executive Office of the President.
- (4)** Not later than 5 days after the President transmits a nomination for Attorney General to the Senate, the nominee shall disclose to the Committee on the Judiciary of the Senate and to the Director of the Office of Government Ethics all facts reasonably necessary to determine compliance with this subsection. The nominee shall update the disclosure not later than the date of the first hearing to consider the nomination if additional responsive information becomes known.
- (5)** Before final committee action on the nomination, the Director of the Office of Government Ethics shall review the disclosure submitted under paragraph (4), consult as appropriate with the Department of Justice Designated Agency Ethics Official, and transmit to the Committee on the Judiciary of the Senate a written determination identifying whether the disclosed facts indicate compliance with this subsection. The determination shall not bind the Senate in exercising its advice-and-consent function and shall not preclude judicial review under paragraph (6).
- (6)(A)** An individual whose eligibility or continued service is governed by this subsection, or a person subject to a criminal prosecution, civil enforcement action, subpoena, compulsory process, or other Department of Justice action personally authorized, directed, supervised, or substantially participated in by an officer alleged to be serving in violation of this subsection, may bring a civil action in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia for declaratory or prospective injunctive relief concerning compliance with this subsection.
- (B)** An action under this paragraph shall receive expedited consideration.
- (C)** No indictment, conviction, judgment, subpoena, civil enforcement action, settlement, order, agency action, or other Department of Justice act shall be dismissed, vacated, suppressed, or otherwise invalidated solely because of a violation of this subsection unless another provision of law independently authorizes that remedy and the party seeking relief demonstrates particularized prejudice.
- (7)** If any provision of this subsection, or its application to any person or circumstance, is held invalid, the remainder of the subsection and its application to other persons or circumstances shall not be affected.

Section 504 of title 28, United States Code, is amended by designating the existing text as subsection (a) and adding at the end the following:

- (b)** The eligibility restriction, disclosure requirement, ethics-review provision, expedited-review provision, and severability rule set forth in section 503(b) apply in the same manner to appointment to, or service in, the office of Deputy Attorney General.

Section 504a of title 28, United States Code, is amended by adding at the end the following:

- The eligibility restriction, disclosure requirement, ethics-review provision, expedited-review provision, and severability rule set forth in section 503(b) apply in the same manner to appointment to, or service in, the office of Associate Attorney General.

Budgetary Impact Statement

Administrative workload is possible through nominee disclosure, OGE review, DOJ ethics consultation, Senate review, and occasional expedited judicial review; no new appropriation is specified and no dollar estimate is assigned.

Note: Preliminary ARRP assessment only; not a CBO, OMB, agency, or legislative-counsel score.

Drafting Notes

- The seven-year period tracks the general lower-grade cooling-off period currently used in 10 U.S.C. § 113(a)(2)(A).
- The rule excludes official government representation so that service as White House Counsel, agency counsel, or another government lawyer is not automatically disqualifying merely because the lawyer represented the institutional presidency or the United States.
- The phrase “could reasonably diverge” is intended to capture personal or political representation presenting a foreseeable institutional conflict while avoiding a prohibition covering every legal service associated with a President.
- Extension to the Deputy Attorney General uses the existing office-specific statutory hook in 28 U.S.C. § 504 and corrects the earlier remedy mismatch between a Deputy Attorney General manifestation and Attorney General-only bill text.
- Extension to the Associate Attorney General uses 28 U.S.C. § 504a and tracks the succession role of that office under 28 U.S.C. § 508.
- The five-day disclosure timing tracks the nominee financial-disclosure timing Congress already uses in 5 U.S.C. § 13103(b).
- The Office of Government Ethics review role uses existing OGE conflict-review and corrective-action authority in 5 U.S.C. § 13122 while preserving the Senate's independent advice-and-consent role.
- The judicial-review provision is narrowed to the covered individual and people directly subject to DOJ action substantially involving the allegedly ineligible official. This is intended to improve Article III standing and avoid generalized taxpayer, voter, or legislator standing theories.
- The remedial-limit provision is intended to reduce de facto-officer disruption by preventing automatic invalidation of DOJ actions absent an independent remedial basis and particularized prejudice.
- No individual eligibility waiver is included. Congress could enact one by later legislation if an extraordinary case justified it.
- Further refinement should address whether the rule should extend to other specified senior DOJ offices.

Authority Notes

28 U.S.C. § 503 creates the office of Attorney General, prescribes presidential appointment with Senate advice and consent, and designates the Attorney General as head of the Department of Justice.

28 U.S.C. § 504 authorizes the President to appoint a Deputy Attorney General by and with the advice and consent of the Senate.

28 U.S.C. § 504a authorizes the President to appoint an Associate Attorney General by and with the advice and consent of the Senate.

28 U.S.C. § 508 places the Deputy Attorney General and Associate Attorney General in the statutory order for exercising Attorney General duties during a vacancy, absence, or disability.

10 U.S.C. § 113(a)(2) imposes a seven-year or ten-year cooling-off period, depending on grade, for certain former regular commissioned officers before appointment as Secretary of Defense.

5 U.S.C. § 13103(b) requires Senate-confirmation nominees to file financial disclosure reports within five days after nomination transmittal and update them before the first hearing.

5 U.S.C. § 13122 gives the Director of the Office of Government Ethics executive-branch conflict-prevention, disclosure-review, investigation, corrective-action, and advisory responsibilities.

Appendix B - Technical Framework

American Restoration and Resilience Project — Technical Framework

This file contains the project's technical operating framework: method, issue architecture, evidence standards, remedy standards, repository structure, file conventions, and canonical development backlog. It also points to the separate files governing print assembly, contribution expectations, public release, audit scoring, source tracking, and remedy taxonomy.

The project's public-facing premise, mission, scope, and governing principles are maintained in `./README.md`.

Repository Architecture

- `./README.md` contains the public-facing proposal front matter, including the reader notice, foundational premise, mission, scope, governing principles, rights notice, citation pointer, and technical-framework pointer.
- `framework/` contains governing methodology and cross-cutting remedial architecture.
- `areas/` contains one directory per project area, area README indexes, developed issue pages, and sibling issue audit-history files.
- `legislation/` contains proposed statutory, constitutional, regulatory, procedural, and model-state language keyed to issue identifiers.
- `inventory/` contains structured area, issue, contents, audit, and source records.
- `./AUDIT_DASHBOARD.md` contains the compact cross-issue audit dashboard for meta-analysis and audit planning.
- `./CHANGE_AUDIT_LOG.md` contains cumulative project-wide Change Audit history.
- `./HORIZON_SCAN.md` contains cumulative horizon-scan intake, recommendations, adjudications, and integration history.
- `./PROJECT_STRUCTURE.md` contains the repository map for human orientation.
- `research/` contains material not yet integrated into a developed issue.
- `source-development/` contains source-development work products and crosswalks not yet fully absorbed into issue pages, inventories, or proposed legislation.
- `scripts/` contains project-maintenance and export-generation scripts.
- `exports/` contains generated DOCX, PDF, and XLSX editions.
- `archive/` contains superseded snapshots retained for provenance.

Markdown and CSV files are authoritative. Binary Office and PDF files are generated outputs.

Canonical Sources

- `FRAMEWORK.md` — technical framework, repository conventions, and development status
- `./inventory/areas.csv` — structured area inventory
- `./inventory/issues.csv` — structured issue inventory
- `./inventory/contents.csv` — combined area-and-issue contents index
- `./inventory/audits.csv` — issue-level audit status and proposal-quality scoring
- `./inventory/sources.csv` — source-tracking table
- `METHODOLOGY.md` — inventory maintenance, audit procedure, scoring rules, and Horizon Scan rules
- `REMEDY_FRAMEWORK.md` — remedy categories, trigger stages, and cross-cutting remedial options
- `./areas/` — modular area and issue analyses
- `./legislation/` — draft statutory and administrative language keyed to issue identifiers
- `./AUDIT_DASHBOARD.md` — compact cross-issue audit tracker for meta-analysis and audit planning
- `./CHANGE_AUDIT_LOG.md` — cumulative Change Audit history
- `./HORIZON_SCAN.md` — cumulative Horizon Scan intake and integration ledger
- `./PROJECT_STRUCTURE.md` — human-readable repository map
- `./AUTHORS.md` — authorship statement
- `./LICENSE.md` — rights and reuse notice

- ../CITATION.cff — citation metadata
- ../CONTRIBUTING.md — contribution expectations
- ../PUBLIC_RELEASE.md — public release process
- ../source-development/ — source-development work products and crosswalks
- ../scripts/ — project-maintenance and export-generation scripts
- ../exports/ — generated, non-authoritative export files
- PRINT_ASSEMBLY.md — compiled-document and print assembly framework

Inventory Status and Development Phase

Current area and issue status is maintained in ../inventory/areas.csv, ../inventory/issues.csv, and the ordered contents scaffold in ../inventory/contents.csv. ../areas/README.md and area README files provide human-readable indexes, while developed issue pages contain the substantive analysis. Do not duplicate current area lists, issue lists, or developed-issue status snapshots in this framework file unless the list is generated from the inventory.

Project updates must keep the structured inventory, audit dashboard, Change Audit log, and Horizon Scan ledger current. When an area, issue, legislation file, audit status, quality score, or cited source is added, removed, renamed, merged, retired, or materially revised, update the relevant rows in ../inventory/areas.csv, ../inventory/issues.csv, ../inventory/contents.csv, ../inventory/audits.csv, ../inventory/sources.csv, and ../AUDIT_DASHBOARD.md as part of the same change. When a Change Audit is run, update ../CHANGE_AUDIT_LOG.md as part of the same change. When a HOR-### candidate is added, adjudicated, integrated, retained, or retired, update ../HORIZON_SCAN.md as part of the same change.

The project will proceed by applying this framework to retained issues, developing authoritative source records, resolving overlap through primary ownership and cross-reference, and revising the least-complex adequate remedy as legal and factual analysis matures.

The governing framework incorporates the project-wide rules for institutional focus, politically neutral application, issue admission, mandatory issue architecture, issue-level conciseness, standardized annotations, the Least-Complex Adequate Remedy, limited use of automatic institutional-failure triggers, audit sidecars, source tracking, print assignment, and cross-referencing instead of duplicative treatment.

File and Metadata Conventions

Every substantive issue has a stable identifier such as DOJ-001. Legislative proposal files use the issue identifier as the base filename.

- Federal legislative proposals use the unsuffixed issue identifier: XXX-NNN.md.
- Model state legislative proposals use the state suffix: XXX-NNN-state.md.

For issues with both federal and state proposals, the federal proposal is the unsuffixed file and the model state proposal is the -state file. For issues with only a model state proposal, the proposal should still use the -state suffix.

Examples:

- ELEC-003.md — federal proposal.
- ELEC-003-state.md — model state proposal.
- ELEC-002-state.md — model state proposal where no federal proposal is yet maintained.

Every Markdown page must carry print_levels metadata under PRINT_ASSEMBLY.md.

Neutrality and Language Guidelines

The project applies neutral standards without pretending to be neutral about institutional harm. Language should help a skeptical but fair reader understand the project as structural reform analysis rather than campaign argument, while still naming abuse, corruption, illegality, coercion, falsehood, or institutional damage when the record supports those descriptions.

Institutional Focus

Frame issues around institutional weakness, structural damage, and legal repair. Name individual actors only when their conduct is necessary to understand the failure, source the example, or explain the remedy.

Neutral Application

Apply the same evidentiary, legal, and remedial standards regardless of party, ideology, officeholder, administration, or movement. Do not create partisan exemptions, manufacture false equivalence, make unsupported accusations for balance, or design rules that depend on who currently holds power.

Public-Actor References

Project-authored prose should use office-respecting, institutionally neutral references for public actors when doing so improves precision and avoids avoidable partisan tone. For example, use **President Trump** rather than **Trump** or **Donald Trump** when referring to him as an officeholder, actor, or case-study subject in the project's own analysis.

This convention does not alter exact source material. Preserve formal case names, article titles, source titles, URLs, direct quotations, formal legal labels, and other citation text exactly as written unless the underlying source itself is being corrected or replaced.

When a phrase such as **Trump-era**, **anti-Trump**, or **pre-Trump** appears in project-authored prose, rewrite it into a more precise institutional formulation, such as **incidents from President Trump's administration, framed as targeting President Trump**, or **pre-2017 institutional status quo**, as context requires.

Accuracy Over Softening

Neutrality does not require euphemism. If the record supports a term such as **unlawful**, **false**, **retaliatory**, **corrupt**, **coercive**, **abusive**, or **pretextual**, use the accurate term and cite the supporting basis. If the record is incomplete, contested, pending, or inferential, identify that limitation directly.

Motive and Intent

Do not state motive, bad faith, corrupt purpose, retaliation, or pretext as fact unless supported by findings, admissions, contemporaneous records, credible reporting, or a clearly explained documented inference. Use qualified formulations such as **may indicate**, **raises concern**, **alleged**, **reported**, or **not yet adjudicated** when the record requires qualification.

Conduct Before Character

Avoid standalone character labels and ideological epithets where a conduct-based description would be more precise. Instead of relying on labels such as **authoritarian**, **fascist**, **extremist**, or **radical**, describe the mechanism: concentration of removal power, weakened adjudicatory independence, reduced reviewability, coercive use of funding, manipulation of factual records, or similar institutional effects.

Project 2025 Treatment

Treat Project 2025 and comparable ideological programs as source material for institutional-risk analysis, not as partisan enemy documents. The project may state its opposition to unitary executive theory, institutional capture, and efforts to subordinate public institutions to personal or factional control, but analysis should focus on the mechanism, legal vulnerability, implementation pathway, and institutional effect.

Collective Labels

Avoid loaded collective labels that imply every Republican, conservative, Trump voter, Democrat, progressive, independent, or other broad political group supports the conduct or institutional weakness being analyzed. Use narrower sourced formulations such as **MAGA-aligned**, **Project 2025-associated**, **President Trump's administration**, **the administration**, **the proposal's sponsors**, or **identified supporters** only when analytically necessary.

Coalition Reality

The project should not describe itself as a Democratic Party agenda or allow likely audience interest to substitute for institutional analysis. It may, however, acknowledge that certain proposals are likely to be more immediately interesting to Democratic, independent, civil-libertarian, good-government, institutionalist, or other audiences because of the present political alignment of the abuses being studied. That coalition reality should inform adoption analysis, objection handling, and framing, but it should not change the evidentiary standard, legal analysis, remedy design, or neutrality of application.

Advocacy Tone

Avoid campaign-style language such as **fight back**, **defeat**, **crush**, **resist**, **anti-Trump**, or **pro-democracy side** in proposal analysis. Prefer institutional verbs such as **repair**, **prevent recurrence**, **constrain**, **restore**, **stabilize**, **harden**, **detect**, **correct**, **deter**, and **contain**.

Analytical Method

Identify the problem. Determine what institution or governing process failed, how the failure manifested, and what damage resulted.

Identify the weakness. Determine which law, structure, procedure, remedy, or norm permitted the failure or proved inadequate to constrain it.

Identify repair and prevention. Determine what must be restored or corrected now and what safeguards are necessary to prevent recurrence.

Identify the least-complex adequate remedy. Determine the least-complex measure, or package of measures, capable of adequately addressing the defect.

Issue-Admission Test

Before promoting a candidate into a standalone issue, ask:

Does this candidate identify a distinct institutional weakness requiring separate diagnosis or remedial analysis?

If not, merge it into a broader issue, treat it as a manifestation or example, cross-reference it, or retain it only in the research inventory.

Candidate issues may be retired or merged when the issue-admission test shows substantial duplication. A status such as **Awaiting merits adjudication** identifies a deliberately paused issue whose remedy depends materially on pending judicial resolution.

Unit of Analysis

Each issue must identify a generalized structural defect. Incidents from President Trump's administration or any other administration illustrate the defect but do not define it.

Overlap and Cross-Reference Rule

Each institutional defect should have one primary home. Related areas should cross-reference the primary issue instead of repeating the same diagnosis, evidence, and remedy. The issue inventory may identify related areas without creating duplicate substantive sections.

Mandatory Issue Architecture

Every developed issue should use the following structure:

1. **Issue Snapshot** — a short reader-navigation box summarizing problem, repair, and vehicle.
2. **Institutional Anomaly** — a concise, generalized statement of the structural defect.
3. **Manifestation of the Failure** — only the representative facts necessary to show how the defect operates.
4. **Resulting Damage** — the principal institutional, legal, factual, administrative, or legitimacy harm.
5. **Underlying Weakness** — the law, structure, procedure, remedy, or norm that failed.
6. **Proposal Survey** — concise review of prior or adjacent models bearing on the remedy.
7. **Least-Complex Adequate Remedy** — the least-complex measure or package capable of adequately addressing the defect.
8. **Repair and Prevention** — restoration or correction of existing damage and prospective safeguards against recurrence.
9. **Proposed Legislation** — link to the proposed legislative, rule, constitutional, or procedural vehicle when one exists.
10. **Budgetary Impact Statement** — a concise preliminary fiscal classification using the project rubric.
11. **Proposal Scoring** — a succinct audit and scoring box showing the proposal-quality score, any companion scores, Required Electoral Environment, Development Priority, and any assessed coalition-support estimates first, separated by an em dash divider from audit status, rubric version, rebaseline status, next audit need, and a link to the sibling full audit-history file.
12. **Annotation** — evidence, legal analysis, qualifications, alternatives, and implementation constraints.

The headings guide analysis but do not require artificial expansion. Each section should add a distinct proposition.

Custom section headings are permitted where they make a developed issue clearer or more natural to read, provided the issue still performs the required analytical functions. A custom heading should be meaningfully distinct from the canonical heading it replaces rather than a trivial restatement. Where custom headings are used, the required function should remain clear from the heading itself, the surrounding structure, or a short orienting sentence.

Where proposed legislation or another concrete reform vehicle exists, the issue page should include a **Proposed Legislation** section immediately after **Repair and Prevention**. **Repair and Prevention** and **Proposed Legislation** should appear after **Least-Complex Adequate Remedy**, so the page first compares available models and identifies the preferred remedy before presenting the repair frame and concrete vehicle. Proposed vehicles should always be presented as a Markdown bullet list, even when there is only one linked item.

Candidate or source-development pages may keep a **Proposed Legislation** section with a single **Pending development** bullet when no draft vehicle exists yet. That placeholder is a development-status marker, not a legislation link failure. Once a concrete vehicle exists, replace the placeholder with a linked bullet and update the Issue Snapshot vehicle line, metadata, inventories, and dashboard.

Where a proposal is legally available under current law but depends on a future or amenable institutional actor for realistic adoption, the issue page may include an **Adoption Viability Note** immediately after **Proposed Legislation**. The note should be concise and should distinguish legal vehicle availability from practical adoption likelihood.

Where a proposal may be confused with, overlap with, partially replace, or depend on another ARRP proposal, the issue page should include an optional **Relationship to Adjacent Proposals** section after **Proposed Legislation** and any **Adoption Viability Note**, but before **Budgetary Impact Statement**. The section should briefly identify what the current proposal owns, what each adjacent proposal owns, whether there is partial overlap or merger, and whether the adjacent proposal complements or replaces the current remedy.

The issue page and its linked proposed legislation must remain substantively aligned. When either page changes, the next framework, drafting, or project-integration audit should cross-check the Issue Snapshot vehicle, Least-Complex Adequate Remedy, Repair and Prevention, Proposed Legislation, Annotation, and Proposal Scoring summary against the linked legislative or rule text. The check should confirm that the issue page still accurately describes the vehicle, covered actors, legal hook, remedy type, enforcement mechanism, deadlines, responsible institutions, scope limits, and material drafting notes. If an audit discovers a substantive discrepancy, document it as an unresolved finding, report it to the user, and treat it as requiring human review before updating either the issue page or the proposed legislation.

Every developed issue page and every proposal page should include a **Budgetary Impact Statement** before **Annotation** on issue pages and before **Drafting Notes** on legislation or proposal pages. The statement is a preliminary ARRP planning classification, not an official fiscal score. It must be short, source-conscious, and must not include a dollar figure unless the figure is tied to a cited government source, historical appropriation, CBO score, agency budget material, audited program cost, or comparable source-backed basis. The substantive classification should appear first. The project disclaimer should appear below it as an italicized note: *Note: Preliminary ARRP assessment only; not a CBO, OMB, agency, or legislative-counsel score.*

Use one of the following baseline classifications unless a source-backed estimate justifies a narrower formulation:

- No direct appropriation is anticipated.
- Administrative workload is possible; no new appropriation is specified.
- Budget authority is likely required; no dollar estimate is assigned pending source-backed cost data.
- Not estimated pending proposal development.
- No direct appropriation is anticipated for the amendment itself; implementing legislation may have costs.
- Budget authority may be required if the chosen remedy funds postage, tracking, or election-administration support; no dollar estimate is assigned pending source-backed cost data.

When a proposal authorizes appropriations or clearly requires new funded capacity, use the budget-authority classification unless a tighter source-backed range is available. When a proposal is a constitutional amendment, distinguish the amendment itself from later implementing legislation.

Issue Snapshot Format

Each developed issue page should place an **Issue Snapshot** blockquote immediately after the issue title and before **Institutional Anomaly**. The snapshot is a reader-navigation device: it should let a reader move quickly from problem to proposed solution without reading the full issue page first.

The Issue Snapshot should be extremely concise. Each line should normally convey its point in about twelve words or fewer. To render consistently in both GitHub and Codex previews, keep the snapshot fields in a single blockquote paragraph and separate **Problem**, **Repair**, and **Vehicle** with inline tags:

1. **Problem:** the institutional weakness.
2. **Repair:** the core proposed fix.
3. **Vehicle:** the legal or institutional form of the remedy, with a relative Markdown link to proposed legislation or amendment text where a draft exists.

Use this format:

```
> ## Issue Snapshot
> **Problem:** Short problem statement.
**Repair:** Short repair statement.
**Vehicle:** Remedy vehicle ([draft link]).
>
```

Proposal Survey

Each developed issue should include a concise survey of prior legislative, regulatory, constitutional, procedural, or institutional models that bear on the proposed remedy. The survey should identify the closest models, cite or link them, and explain why the project adopts, narrows, rejects, or combines them. It should appear before **Least-Complex Adequate Remedy** so the preferred remedy follows the comparison.

Issue-Level Conciseness

Conciseness is an area-level and issue-level constraint, not an overall document-length limit. Each issue should be stated in the minimum space necessary to identify the defect, damage, weakness, repair, prevention, and remedy. Additional detail belongs in annotation or source notes.

Representative incidents should illustrate the structural defect, not become exhaustive narrative histories.

Annotation and Evidence

Standard Annotation

Each annotation segment should begin with a bold inline title followed by a period, then the paragraph text.

Basis and Evidence. Explain why the anomaly has been identified and cite representative authoritative support.

Qualification. State material uncertainty, competing interpretations, and limits necessary to keep the main assertion accurate.

Remedial Alternatives and Constraints. Briefly identify materially serious fallback options and the constitutional, statutory, administrative, or practical limits affecting the least-complex remedy.

Budgetary Impact. Explain any fiscal, workload, or implementation-burden classification that needs more support than the short Budgetary Impact Statement can provide.

Scoring annotations should mirror the labels used in the **Proposal Scoring** box where practical. Use **Quality Score**, **Adoption Score**, **Coalition Support Estimates**, **Adoption Friction**, **Required Electoral Environment**, and **Development Priority** as needed. Place these scoring annotation segments after **Budgetary Impact** when they appear, so score explanations can incorporate fiscal, implementation, adoption, friction, and readiness findings without crowding the Proposal Scoring box.

When the **Proposal Scoring** box includes **Coalition Support Estimates**, keep the box visually compact: put the label on its own line, then list each audience estimate on indented lines using inline breaks and spacing. Do not place evidentiary caveats such as "provisional," "not polling," or "stakeholder judgment" in the compact scoring box when the same point is explained in the matching **Coalition Support Estimates** annotation segment.

Use this compact format when coalition estimates are displayed:

```
> **Coalition Support Estimates:**  
    Democratic 80%  
    Independent 60%  
    Republican 40%  
    Bipartisan viability 55%
```

Assertion Discipline

State each institutional conclusion as directly as the record permits. An annotation must substantiate rather than retreat from the main assertion. Distinguish established fact, legal conclusion, institutional inference, and normative judgment.

Source Standard

Use primary legal and governmental records first. Use authoritative institutional and academic sources for doctrine, design, and comparative analysis. Use high-quality secondary reporting mainly for synthesis and discovery.

Every factual, legal, and causal proposition must remain independently supportable. When an issue file refers to a real-life event, case, official action, report, statute, rule, hearing, order, or other source material, include a nearby citation or link. Do not name concrete examples in issue text without enough source information for later verification.

Source inventory updates are required whenever a new external source is cited or an existing cited source is repurposed for a materially different proposition. A source may remain marked **Reviewed?** as **NO** until verification is complete, but the citation should still be captured promptly.

When referring to another page in this project, use a relative Markdown link whenever the target page exists. If the referenced issue exists only as an inventory or area-index entry, link to the nearest project page that contains that entry.

Least-Complex Adequate Remedy

The Least-Complex Adequate Remedy is mandatory in every developed issue and functions as the project's provisional preferred remedy.

Complexity should be assessed by legal difficulty, administrative burden, implementation speed, enforceability, durability, cost, and need for constitutional change. Simplicity is not sufficient where the simpler measure would be ineffective, temporary, unenforceable, or easily evaded.

The main text need not catalogue every conceivable remedy. It should identify the least-complex adequate measure or package and explain why it is adequate. Annotation should briefly note materially simpler but insufficient options and more complex fallback options that may be necessary for completeness, durability, or constitutional reasons.

Adequacy should be evaluated against the remedy's proper function. Where prevention is feasible, the remedy should prevent. Where necessary discretion or constitutional structure makes complete prevention impracticable, adequacy may instead require reliable detection, evidence preservation, independent review, mandatory reporting, correction, discipline, compensation, legislative response, or another credible self-corrective mechanism.

The assessment remains provisional rather than irrevocable and may be revised as the record develops.

Repair and Prevention

Every issue must consider both repair and prevention. Some issues may require restoration, investigation, disclosure, recovery, correction of the public record, rebuilding of capacity, or compensation. Prevention may require substantive legal limits, structural independence, professional safeguards, oversight, enforcement, transparency, procedural reform, or constitutional change.

The distinction is mandatory to consider but need not receive equal prose where one side is not materially relevant. Issues should also identify whether the proposed safeguard primarily prevents, detects, corrects, deters, or contains institutional abuse.

Constitutional Amendments

Constitutional amendments are within scope and must not be excluded. Adequate non-amendment remedies should generally receive greater emphasis because Article V is unusually difficult and slow. Amendment options must nevertheless be preserved where lesser measures cannot lawfully, completely, or durably solve the problem.

Automatic Constitutional Stabilizers and Institutional-Failure Triggers

A constitutional system should not permit persistent failure of essential governing processes to continue indefinitely without changing the legal allocation of power.

Trigger mechanisms are a limited, cross-cutting remedial tool. They may include mandatory notice, fixed deadlines, compulsory votes, expiration of temporary authority, caretaker succession, expedited review, temporary contraction of discretionary authority, or constitutional mechanisms for extraordinary cumulative failure.

Triggers are not a universal solution and do not organize or subsume the rest of the project. Apply them only where persistent institutional failure can be addressed through objective, measurable, proportionate, manipulation-resistant escalation or reallocation mechanisms. Many issues will instead require substantive limits, structural independence, disclosure, professional safeguards, enforcement, oversight, funding reform, or constitutional change.

Proposal Quality Audit

Before an issue or proposal is treated as ready for external circulation, it should undergo a quality audit. The framework requirement is structural: developed issue pages must expose a compact **Proposal Scoring** section, link to the sibling full audit-history file, and keep scoring visible without overloading the main issue page.

The canonical audit rules, resource tiers, Horizon Scan procedure, hallucination-resistance protocol, scoring formula, adoption-score formula, international-support score, output requirements, and audit-preservation rules are maintained in `METHODOLOGY.md`.

The **Proposal Scoring** section should group all scores and viability indicators at the top, followed by an em dash divider and then audit status, routing fields, rubric version, rebaseline status, and the audit-history link. `./AUDIT_DASHBOARD.md` provides the compact cross-issue view.

Outstanding Development

The following canonical backlog items remain outstanding:

- develop authoritative source records, annotations, and individual issue files for remaining JUD, PAR, and CLASS candidate issues;
- analyze constitutional and implementation constraints for judicial-enforcement remedies, including appointments, appropriations, due process, and presidential control;
- analyze the constitutional limits on restricting the legal effect of presidential clemency while developing transparency, anti-corruption, review, recordkeeping, disclosure, and surrounding-liability remedies;
- preserve and source the distinctions among classification status, authorization to disclose, lawful custody or possession, and government ownership and records-preservation duties;
- develop the A-21 annotation explaining the systemic risks of sustained political subordination of monetary policy, including inflation, unanchored expectations, leverage, asset-price distortions, currency weakness, loss of credibility, and the possibility of a later severe corrective contraction;
- conduct a systematic review of each proposal's potential bipartisan support, including cross-party institutional interests, likely objections, possible neutral framing, and risks of partisan capture or misuse;
- complete the Project 2025 / ARRP crosswalk source-development pass, including official Mandate chapter records, chapter-level and major-proposal rows, page or section citations, implementation-status labels, weakness-vehicle analysis for proposals whether or not enacted or attempted, ARRP area and issue mappings, coverage-status labels, newly needed issue candidates, and area-priority review;
- maintain and improve the compiled-export workflow, including table-of-contents generation, heading normalization, local-link verification, appendix placement for proposed legislation, and compact document layout;

- defer full page-numbered and clickable table-of-contents work until the project is more developed, then limit it to major sections, project areas, developed issues, and appendices;
- select and adopt an appropriate Creative Commons or other public reuse license when the project is ready for broader legislative and public engagement.

These are substantive research and issue-development tasks, not exceptions to the governing framework above.